Lu Zhang

Virtual Production | Motion Capture | Technical Art and VFX

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Portfolio: https://nerawo.github.io/portfolio-2026/index.html

Virtual production experience in optical motion capture, performance capture, and motion data preparation, supported by procedural tool development and live-action VFX compositing.

Education

Savannah College of Art and Design (SCAD) – United States

M.F.A. in Visual Effects

Sep 2025 – Dec 2027

- Relevant Coursework: VFX Compositing, Technical Art & Tool Development, Look Development & Shading

Simon Fraser University (SFU) – Canada

B.A. in Interactive Design

Sep 2020 – Apr 2025

- Coursework: Interaction Design, Web Design, Graphic Design, Communication, Film Production, Publishing

Experience

Versatile Media —Zhejiang, China

Motion Capture Intern

Jun 2026 – Sep 2026

- Supported optical motion capture workflows, including mocap system preparation, marker placement, performer calibration, and motion data acquisition for virtual production projects.
- Assisted with motion capture data processing workflows, including data review, organization, naming conventions, and preparation for downstream animation pipelines.
- Gained hands-on experience with motion capture technologies, including optical tracking systems, facial capture equipment, virtual cameras, and real-time production tools.
- Assisted in improving motion capture data quality and consistency to meet requirements for character animation and previs workflows.
- Participated in performance capture and real-time production processes, gaining understanding of the full pipeline from motion data acquisition to digital character animation.

Click Convenience Store – Vancouver, Canada

3D Modeler

Sep 2024 – Nov 2024

- Created 3D visualizations of store layouts to support spatial design and visual planning
- Built scenes with accurate structure, materials, and basic lighting for presentation purposes
- Iterated on renders based on design feedback to improve clarity and communication
- Assisted the team in translating design concepts into visual assets for internal use

Projects Experience

Virtual Production Series Project *Motion Capture Production Intern* Jul 2026 – Aug 2026

- Supported character performance capture and motion data management for a motion capture-based production project.
- Assisted with mocap equipment preparation, performer calibration, motion recording, and data organization.
- Collaborated with technical teams to improve motion data quality and support animation production and virtual filming workflows.

Live-Action VFX Compositing – *Echoes of Steam* *Maya | Houdini | Nuke* Jan 2026 – Mar 2026

- Produced a full VFX shot integrating live-action footage with CG elements
- Completed modeling and lighting in Maya; created volumetric smoke and fog simulations in Houdini

- Built a multi-pass rendering pipeline for layered control of volumes, shadows, and reflections
- Composited final shot in Nuke, refining perspective, lighting consistency, and material integration

Procedural Scattering System – Ember Field *Maya | Python* Mar 2026

- Developed a vertex-based procedural scattering system for automated campfire asset generation
- Designed modular asset generation workflows including flames, sparks, and wood structures
- Implemented custom orientation logic (aim constraints) for spatial consistency
- Built a GUI tool to control density and generation rules for improved usability

Documentary – When the Rain Speaks (Team Project)

Assistant Director, Cinematography, Editing, VFX Jan 2025 – Apr 2025

- Produced a documentary exploring memories and emotions of rain within the Squamish community
- Led pre-production: storyboarding, shot planning, and interview structure
- Managed cinematography and on-set coordination to maintain visual consistency
- Completed editing, montage design, and integrated VFX & motion graphics
- Assisted directing and production coordination during filming

Skills

Languages: Chinese (Native), English (Professional working proficiency)

Tools: Maya, Houdini, Nuke, Arnold, Python, After Effects, Premiere, Photoshop, Figma